GMS WEEKLY

Your Source for Recycling News

August 8th, 2025
Week 32
Volume 275, Issue 1197

Highlights:

- **Bizarre reactions.**
- **Trump–Putin meet?**
- **Currency pressures.**
- **Shaky supply.**
- **Occasional buyer.**
- **Scan to download / view the Weekly on the GMS App!**

QUOTE of the WEEK

"When we strive to become better than we are, everything around us becomes better too."

– Paulo Coelho

-- MARKET COMMENTARY --

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LIBERATION DAY!

A week of confusing fundamentals saw nearly all markets reacting bizarrely as upon "Liberation Day" tariffs from back in April finally being levied on key destinations (including India) this week, saw turmoil across the board as the week ended. At the onset, oil futures declined 5% and closed the week out at USD 63.90/barrel as Trump goes after Russian oil purchasing nations, leaving concerns around an upcoming Trump – Putin meeting, which set this week's tone for global oil traders who braced for the unknown, especially as the tariffs announced on Friday even included Russia (rather surprisingly) and China. While the oil futures drop to the tune of 5% was certainly noteworthy, the Baltic Exchange's dry index advance for a third Friday with an over 2% increase certainly left an optimistic air for ship owners of aging assets, especially for the perennially popular cape index that contributed 4.3% to the overall increase, while supras added a marginal 0.2% to the mix. In the interim, the U.S. Dollar gained ground against India, Pakistan, and Turkey (of course), all while declining against both Bangladesh and China this week. Local steel plate prices at the various ship recycling destinations also reciprocated their share of confusion as despite their own differing movements through the week, a majority ended right back where they started.

Trickling down to the recycling markets, the crazy monsoons of 2025 continue to hammer key locations (especially Bangladesh) as ship recyclers, cash buyers, and ship owners collectively come to grips with the new governing realities of the HKC that is now a compelling force in the Indian sub-continent ship recycling markets today – given all of the changing / additional documentation and inward formalities now mandated. An overall shortage of candidates (as compared to recent years) has also left the industry in a state of virtual stasis as the various anchorages displayed the situation as such, even though all locations reported at least one fresh arrival for the week. Prices meanwhile have and continue to endure a turbulent time, with ongoing tariff dramas and even sanction threats that has left a specter of uncertainty looming over key nations including the ship recycling countries, and this has seen levels decline by at least USD 60/LDT since the peaks seen earlier this year. Yard upgrades continue in Bangladesh and even in (a not as paced) Pakistan market where not a single yard is HKC compliant today. And it is this collection of recyclers that is missing their seats at the bidding tables (subject of course those with provisional DASRs at hand).

Along with a shortage of candidates and apart from some large LDT LNG and bulk carriers that have greeted the various anchorages across recent weeks / months, it has been a comparatively busier time than expected in the Indian sub-continent, especially in India where conflictingly, sanctions drama also continues as a vessel was reportedly arrested at Alang. Moreover, until the Putin – Trump meet-up is concluded, the recycling destiny of over a 1,000 ships, including that of the ship recycling industry, hangs in the balance. But with demand still prevalent in India and the occasional buyer(s) popping up in both Pakistan and especially Bangladesh, where HKC approved recyclers who have gone / nearly gone through their prior deliveries, seem to be coming to the fore. At the far-end, Turkey remains dead as ever, with nothing more than a weak currency to confirm.

GMS demo rankings / pricing for week 32 of 2025 are on Page 5.

BANGLADESH

WATCHING ON!

Dilapidated.

The Bangladeshi market has remained watching on from the sidelines since the onset of July and even into August thus far, so inert has the recycling market in Chattogram been over these HKC backed monsoon months. Declining fundamentals critical to the local ship recycling industry along with the ongoing failure of the interim government at stimulating meaningful economic progress via desperately needed infrastructure projects has now become one of the chief antagonists behind this markets decline since June 2024, which has further subjugated Chattogram Choppers into a vicious cycle of volatile / declining fundamentals. Even the previously announced elections of June 30th were cancelled due to domestic instability / communal riots, and this continues to see no traction-worthy implementations from the interim government.

Record-breaking.

It is certainly shocking to see the dilapidated state of affairs given that no other country has breached USD 600/Ton since January 2024, except Bangladesh (of course), who now languish at the bottom of the sub-continent market rankings. And while local steel plate prices declined and dropped about USD 2/Ton, it was the Taka that surprisingly found itself firming by 0.16% against the U.S. Dollar, ending the week at decent (given its recent performance) BDT 121.37, thanks to the recent intervention of the central bank where BDT levels had breached a record-breaking BDT 123 and created panic amongst local businesses involved with international trade and transactions.

Versions of August.

Local recycling yards have reportedly continued their HKC upgrades at pace as HKC certified yard owners continue to burn through their recent deliveries and re-emerge at the bidding tables looking for the next flame. The last couple of weeks have clearly been just such a situation as a fresh batch of arrivals greeted Chattogram's anchorage this week, which included a mix of wet and dry units ranging from small to small-ish LDTs helping Bangladesh end the week with 4 vessels and over 30K LDT, all awaiting the next tide. This was certainly a local confidence booster given that the domestic ship recycling community continues to hemorrhage tonnage to neighboring Pakistan and India, who have both had their own busy versions of August, in light of their firmer prices and open buyers thus far.

Compel.

Mercifully however, news emerged this week that Bangladeshi general elections once again have been announced for February 2026 when hopefully, some meaningful change can take place and the economy is sparked back to construction life. Moreover, despite 30% tariffs being levied on Bangladesh, the RMG (Ready Made Garments) sector recorded a surprising boost for its domestic share of Bangladesh's overall international trade, clocking in a near 25% increase thus far, when compared to all of 2024. As such, domestic reserves and potential hurdles surround the issuance of L/Cs is hopefully now in the past.

Overall, especially when geography absolutely compels it, we encourage owners to keep an eye out for a possible Bangladeshi recycler who may be back for more.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

INDIA

SANCTION STATION!

Raging.

PM Modi's and India's long-standing relations with Russia, which has helped both countries maintain bi-lateral trade relations especially over the trade of oil, finally witnessed its first shakedown this week as a raging Trump blanket sanctioned countries, trading partners, companies, and even single entities, in the wake of Putin's ongoing and uncontrollable aggression against Ukraine, thereby (temporarily?) strangling the future of uncountable businesses and recycling assets in the wake of. And it was August 1st that saw President "two weeks' finally drop the hammer along with 50% tariffs against all Indian exports to the U.S. Though this news was forthcoming late U.S. hours and global markets had already closed for the week, next week will certainly be one to keep an eye out for, given the proclivity of local recyclers to always maintain a nervy mindset.

Destination confusion.

Notwithstanding the awaiting fallout, local fundamentals were already having a bad week as not only did local steel plate prices climb a mountain and come back down to the same level as the week ended, but the Indian Rupee also lost 26 basis points against the U.S. Dollar to end the week at Rs. 87.50. This is reminiscent of the time Rs. 88 had been breached and local offerings started immediately retreating thereafter, resulting in a few sub-USD 400/LDT sales taking place into Alang. Should this decline in the Rupee continue, India might just slip past Bangladesh into 3rd place, which would create a destination confusion as on the one hand, neighbouring destinations would have firmer offerings but a cripplingly limited number of open recyclers available at the bidding tables while on the other hand, even though India has both, it is the numbers that might become the bitter pill to swallow.

Seeking alternatives.

For now however, local offerings stand in place as the week ended and local anchorage was even greeted by the arrival of another large LDT bulker, leaving Alang with 6 vessels and nearly 57K LDT, although a couple have been facing delivery issues for some time now. Moreover, as the EU wraps up their own tariff dealings with the White House, Indian authorities speed up their discussions with the EU and various other nations in seeking viable energy alternatives, all while the anticipated Trump – Putin meeting and tariffs now loom on the horizon.

Go to place?

Notwithstanding, India has been the beneficiary of, and will continue to be the recipient of high profile and large LDT LNGs that have masked what has been an overall worrying summer of minimal activity and declining prices, despite a majority of local recyclers having yard capacity and having been HKC approved for some time now. The irony of India's HKC only pride will eventually be compromised as competing markets play catch up and India may not see the influx of HKC only candidates as it has historically been accustomed to. Although blue-chip ship owners may still see otherwise in the short term.

For now, nothing other than watch this space for how all markets react, even though Alang remains the go to place for now.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

PAKISTAN

STEADY AS SHE ROLLS!

Keenly offering.

Pakistani buyers have been willfully and keenly offering on any of the small number of vessels that have been having "meerkat moments" at the bidding tables i.e. owners taking a quick peek into the ship recycling spaces and see where levels stand as some of the truly aged beauties (some built even in the 90s) are still trading the open seas and it's not when, but just how soon these will end up at one of the sub-continent recycling shores.

In the interim, for those that have been making the rounds of the bidding tables, Pakistani recyclers seem to be the most eager for tonnage while still mindful of the fact that they have a significant amount of catching up to do with competing neighbors, where yard and infrastructure upgrades are concerned in order for Gadani to finally fall in line with the convention.

DASR gives time.

The local government and relevant ministries have also been issuing provisional DASR certificates to those yards who have demonstrated their share of upgrades, and this continues to help a malnourished ship recycling fraternity drip-feed itself with meaningful tonnage over recent weeks, including this one, where another nearly 9K LDT woodchip carrier arrived the nation's waterfront.

Domestic fundamentals have remained relatively unchanged, especially local steel plate prices that have essentially nailed themselves to the floor at USD 615/Ton for months now. Disappointingly yet, Gadani recyclers have been unable (?) / unwilling (?) to take advantage of this massive buffer in the resale of recycled steel during the corresponding time until Indian offers retreated below theirs, invariably leaving Pakistan in 1st place on the marking rankings. The Pakistani Rupee meanwhile raised the specter of uncertainty for local recyclers as the PKR fell nearly 45 basis points and eased back towards PKR 284 against the U.S. Dollar, closing the week out at PKR 283.60.

Nailed.

Overall, Pakistani offerings still remain the highest in the Indian sub-continent for another week, and with tariff uncertainty looming across the board, next week will be one to watch for.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

TURKEY

LIRA…

…that's all she wrote. Having lost 18 basis points and closing the week out at TRY 40.76 against the U.S. Dollar, there's not much else cooking here.

Cooking.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

GMS Weekly – Market Rankings

For Week 32 of 2025, GMS Market Rankings / vessel indications are as below.

Rank	Location	Sentiment	Dry Bulk USD / LDT	Tankers USD / LDT	Containers USD / LDT
1	Pakistan	**Steady**	425 / LDT	445 / LDT	455 / LDT
2	India	**Steady**	415 / LDT	435 / LDT	445 / LDT
3	Bangladesh	**Weak**	405 / LDT	425 / LDT	435 / LDT
4	Turkey	**Weak**	250 / LDT	260 / LDT	270 / LDT

WEIRD ONES!!

- *The component parts of the word helicopter are not 'heli' and 'copter.' It's 'helico,' meaning 'spiral-shaped' like the word 'helix,' and 'pter' meaning 'wing' as in 'pterodactyl.*
- *The tune of the 'Alphabet Song' is actually the 'Twinkle Twinkle Little Star' tune.*
- *Plumbing comes from the root Latin word of 'plumbum', which means lead, and is the reason it's Pb on the Periodic table. The Romans made water pipes out of lead.*
- *Most of the oxygen we breathe doesn't actually come from trees. When you were in school, you probably learned about how trees and other plants use carbon dioxide — what we breathe out — in the process of photosynthesis, which creates oxygen — what we breathe in — as a byproduct. People often assume that most of the oxygen we breathe comes from trees or other plant-dense forests, but that's not true. According to National Geographic, only about 28% of oxygen on Earth comes from rainforests. The majority of it — somewhere between 50% and 85% — actually comes from marine plants, like kelp and phytoplankton in the ocean.*
- *Sharks are older than the rings of Saturn. Saturn's rings are estimated to be no more than 400 million years old. Comparatively, sharks date back to the Late Ordovician Period, or about 450 million years ago.*
- *Earth famously has one moon. But in 2024, our planet gained a bonus "mini moon," thanks to the asteroid 2024 PT5. The asteroid traveled in a horseshoe-like orbit around Earth for about two months before continuing its journey through the solar system. It will visit our planet's orbit again in 2055, when it probably won't be close enough to Earth to be moon-y.*

IMPORTANT DATES

INDIA	
BANK HOLIDAYS	**DELIVERY TIDES**
August 15 – Independence Day August 16 - Janmashtami	August 08 – August 16 August 20 – August 27

BANGLADESH	
BANK HOLIDAYS	**DELIVERY TIDES**
August 05 – July Mass Uprising Day August 15 – National Mourning Day August 16 - Janmashtami	August 09 – August 12 August 22 – August 25

BANK HOLIDAYS		
CHINA	**PAKISTAN**	**TURKEY**
No holidays until September	August 14 – Independence Day	August 30 – Victory Day

Prices indicated above are as reported in the market and are not necessarily accurate. This information is provided without prejudice and is given in good faith and without any guarantees whatsoever. While every care has been taken in the preparation of this report, no liability can be accepted for any loss incurred in any way whatsoever by any person relying on the information contained herein. Opinions expressed herein may be deemed subjective and arbitrary. This WEEKLY is intended only for the person or entity to which it is addressed and may contain confidential and/or privileged material. Any review, retransmission, dissemination, or other use of this information by persons or entities other than the intended recipient is prohibited.

ALANG - Port Position as of August 08, 2025

No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	*Aewo*	*5,245*	*Chemical Tanker*	*Delivered August 06*
2	Ange	1,974	Oil Tanker	Arrived July 29
3	**Conica Atlas**	**20,001**	**Oil Tanker**	**Arrived June 13**
4	**Nirvana**	**9,623**	**Oil Tanker**	**Arrived May 07**
6	R Pisces	19,935	Bulk Carrier	Arrived August 05
Total Tonnage		**56,778**		

CHATTOGRAM - Port Position as of August 08, 2025

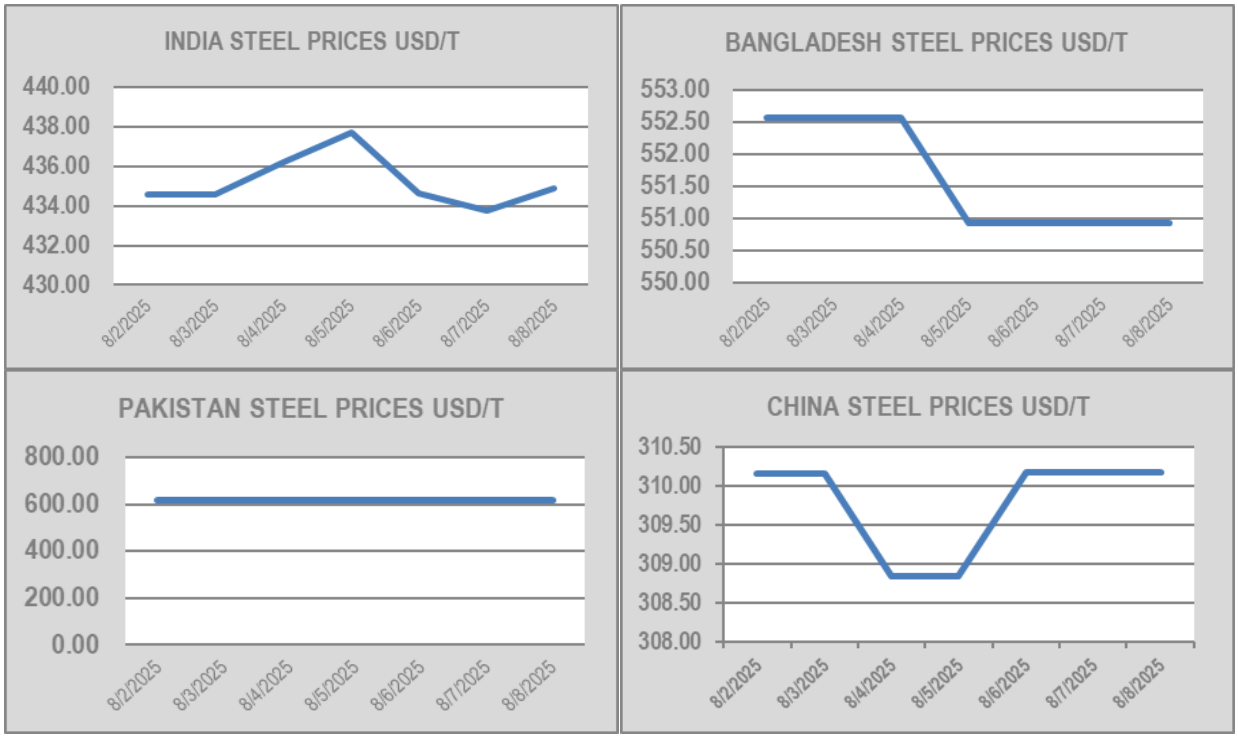
No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	DK 03	7,809	Bulk Carrier	Arrived August 04
2	Great Royal	6,580	Bulk Carrier	Arrived July 28
3	Leonid	13,606	Oil Tanker	Arrived July 28
4	Wond	2,230	Tanker	Arrived August 03
		30,225		

GADANI - Port Position as of August 08, 2025

No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	Best 8	2,571	General Cargo	Arrived July 30
2	Hyun	8,915	Woodchip Carrier	Arrived August 06
Total Tonnage		**11,486**		

WHILE EXTREME CARE HAS BEEN TAKEN IN THE PREPARATION OF THIS REPORT, NO LIABILITY CAN BE ACCEPTED FOR ANY LOSS INCURRED IN ANY WAY WHATSOEVER BY ANY PERSON RELYING ON THE INFORMATION CONTAINED HEREIN.

DATE	INDIA STEEL PRICES USD/T	INDIA STEEL PRICES	PAKISTAN STEEL PRICES USD/T	PAKISTAN STEEL PRICES	BANGLADESH STEEL PRICES USD/T	BANGLADESH STEEL PRICES	CHINA STEEL PRICES USD/T
8/2/2025	434.58	37,600.00	615.44	175,000.00	552.58	67,000.00	310.16
8/3/2025	434.58	37,600.00	615.44	175,000.00	552.58	67,000.00	310.16
8/4/2025	436.19	37,800.00	615.44	175,000.00	552.58	67,000.00	308.85
8/5/2025	437.74	38,000.00	615.44	175,000.00	550.93	66,800.00	308.85
8/6/2025	434.63	38,000.00	615.44	175,000.00	550.93	66,800.00	310.18
8/7/2025	433.79	38,000.00	615.44	175,000.00	550.93	66,800.00	310.18
8/8/2025	434.88	38,000.00	615.44	175,000.00	550.93	66,800.00	310.18



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